servile Arya Samajic institution. Arjan Singh joined the Arya Samaj in 1877, which was only a year after Swami Dayananda Saraswati raised the call for Swaraj. He was the first Sikh to do so. Swami Dayananda Saraswati himself initiated (i.e. gave *diksha)* the Sikh into the fold.[7]

Arjan Singh had plenty of reasons to take this step. In the 1890s, after the British Government in Punjab decided to colonize the forest area, they declared that every colonizer would be awarded 25 acres of free land. In 1897, Arjan Singh had left his native ancestral village of Khatkar Kalya, in Jalandhar district, India, to move to Banga village in Lyallpur. This was a tumultuous time, because as Imran Ali explains, '[t]he great agricultural colonisation schemes undertaken in the western Punjab under British rule turned this area into a virtual human laboratory, as castes, clans, and tribes from different parts of the province converged on the new lands'.[8]

In the unfolding melee, Arjan Singh's entire family was politicized. He had an elder brother, Surjan Singh, who appears to have been no less distinguished because he took part as a delegate at the Lahore Session of the Indian National Congress in 1893, when it was presided over by Dadabhai Naoroji. In 1922, Arjan Singh himself set out for Jaranwala Town to boycott the arrival of foreign cloth in India, instigated by the non-cooperation movement, even though upon his arrival there he learnt that Gandhi had decided to call off the picketing. It was, however, in Banga village itself that Arjan Singh made his lasting contribution. It was not just that he built a Sikh temple (i.e., a *gurudwara*) there. He also dug two wells that still exist. He constructed a guesthouse (i.e., *sarai*) for travellers coming from far and wide. His house was a refuge for revolutionaries and activists, many of whom were engaging in banned activities against the British. He performed the duties of a village doctor (i.e., *hakim*) providing free treatment for the poor. His wife Jai Kaur (Bhagat Singh's grandmother) was no less accomplished, mixing the traditional herbal medicines and preparing them for her husband and acquiring the medical skills of bone-setting for the injured and saving the nationalists who took refuge with them from unsuspecting police raids. According to M.M. Juneja, 'she was perhaps the first woman in Punjab who, by virtue of her welfare activities, had the